TEACHER GUIDE

AQA A-level Business (7132)

Improving motivation and engagement



3.6 Human resource management

3.6.4 Making human resource decisions: improving motivation and engagement

A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise improving motivation and engagement on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	45 min	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same. Your Live screen shows each task and every firm's answer.

1 Herzberg: hygiene

Round 1

You raise pay and fix the cold workshop. Complaints stop, but staff work no harder.

Using Herzberg, why did output not rise?

- **A** Pay and conditions are hygiene factors
- **B** Staff need closer supervision
- **C** Pay is a motivator, but too small
- **D** Staff's esteem needs are already met

ANSWER

✓ Pay and conditions are hygiene factors

Why: Hygiene factors remove dissatisfaction but do not motivate.

2 Staff feel ignored

Round 1

A staff survey says pay is fine, but staff feel ignored.

Which two changes should motivate most?

- **A** Ask staff to help set targets
- **B** A 2% pay rise for all
- **C** Closer checks on their work
- **D** Let teams plan their own work
- **E** A bonus for every car sold

ANSWER

✓ Ask staff to help set targets
✓ Let teams plan their own work

Why: Feeling ignored is not about pay: involvement and trust tackle it.

3 Maslow in order

Round 2

Maslow's hierarchy of needs, at your firm.

Put the needs in order, lowest first?

- **A** Safety: a secure contract
- **B** Esteem: praise for good work
- **C** Social: a friendly team
- **D** Physiological: pay for the basics

ANSWER

1. **Physiological: pay for the basics**
2. **Safety: a secure contract**
3. **Social: a friendly team**
4. **Esteem: praise for good work**

Why: Maslow: physiological, safety, social, then esteem, then self-actualisation.

Topic tasks

4 Piece-rate pay

Round 2

Prep staff are paid per car finished.

Her pay this week?

Pay per car prepared	**£16**
Cars she prepared this week	**46 cars**
Extra per car above 30 cars	**£5**

ANSWER

£816

46 × £16 + 16 × £5 = £816

Why: Piece rate pays for output, so staff work faster, sometimes at the cost of quality.

5 Pay or promotion

Round 3

Sales staff are leaving. Exit interviews say pay is fair, but there is no chance to progress.

What should you offer, and why?

A Training and a clear promotion path

B A higher basic salary

ANSWER

✓ Training and a clear promotion path

Why: Pay is not the problem; a chance to grow and progress meets the need staff named.

6 Maslow: next need

Round 3

A technician has a secure, well-paid job and friends at work, but feels no one values her skill.

Using Maslow, which need should you meet next?

A Social needs

B Esteem needs

C Physiological needs

D Safety needs

ANSWER

✓ Esteem needs

Why: Safety and social needs are met; recognition is an esteem need, which comes next.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on improving motivation and engagement. They come from these 8 questions.

Then each pupil writes one short answer: “Evaluate piece rate pay for your workshop staff.”

1 A workshop manager wants technicians to feel their work matters. Under Herzberg, which is a motivator rather than a hygiene factor?
✔ **Recognition for good work**

2 Technicians complain about cold, badly lit bays. Herzberg would say that fixing them does what?
✔ **Removes dissatisfaction but does not motivate**

3 A dealer’s sales team has secure jobs and fair pay but feels no sense of belonging. Which level of Maslow’s hierarchy is unmet?
✔ **Social (love and belonging) needs**

4 Taylor’s scientific management would pay valeters per car cleaned. What is the main risk for the dealer?
✔ **Quality falls as staff rush to finish more cars**

5 A valeter is paid £9 per car plus a £120 weekly basic. In a week with 38 cars, what is the valeter’s pay?
✔ **£462**

6 Which is a non-financial method of motivating showroom staff?
✔ **Job enrichment**

7 Experienced technicians are allowed to diagnose and schedule their own jobs. Why can this raise motivation?
✔ **Autonomy and responsibility are motivators**

8 A dealer offers a £500 bonus to any salesperson who sells 12 cars in a month. Which type of method is this?
✔ **A financial method of motivation**